



CUDDLES CHILDMINDERS AND SCHOOLS (CCMS)

2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION HOME–SCHOOL PARTNERSHIP

BASIC ELEMENTARY LEVEL 4 (BEL 4)

Dear Parent,

We warmly welcome you and your child to the **2026/2027 Academic Session** at Cuddles Childminders and Schools (CCMS).

BEL 4 represents an important stage in a learner's academic and personal development. At this level, we expect learners to move beyond simply completing tasks to **thinking critically, applying knowledge, solving problems, communicating effectively and taking greater ownership of their learning and behaviour.**

At CCMS, we believe that:

- **Every child is unique** and deserves to be understood, valued and appropriately challenged.
- A strong **home–school partnership** is essential to developing the whole child.
- Learning should be **meaningful, practical and connected to real-life experiences.**
- Children develop confidence when they are given appropriate opportunities to make decisions and take responsibility.
- **Clear expectations and consistent boundaries** help children develop self-discipline and accountability.
- Mistakes should become opportunities for **reflection, correction and growth.**
- **Kindness does not mean the absence of boundaries.** Children can be treated with compassion while still being held accountable.
- High expectations, when paired with appropriate support, encourage children to rise to their potential.

We therefore invite you to partner with us as we support your child in becoming a **confident, capable, responsible and thoughtful learner.**

1.0 COGNITIVE & ACADEMIC EXPECTATIONS

By the end of BEL 4, learners should demonstrate increasing confidence and competence in the following areas:

Mathematics & Mathematical Reasoning

Learners should be able to:

- Read, write, compare and order large numbers using appropriate place-value knowledge.
- Identify and apply even and odd numbers.
- Recognise, complete and create increasingly complex number patterns and sequences.
- Round and estimate numbers and use estimation to check the reasonableness of answers.
- Perform mental addition and subtraction using appropriate strategies.
- Add and subtract multi-digit numbers accurately, including regrouping.
- Multiply and divide using appropriate written and mental strategies.
- Solve multi-step problems involving addition, subtraction, multiplication and division.
- Explain their reasoning and compare different methods of solving a problem.
- Identify factors and multiples at an age-appropriate level.
- Apply fractions to practical situations.
- Identify equivalent fractions and compare and order fractions.
- Work with simple mixed numbers and improper fractions.
- Understand decimals and relate them to fractions and real-life situations.
- Solve practical problems involving money, including totals, change and simple budgeting.
- Solve problems involving time, including elapsed time and timetables.
- Identify, describe and classify common two- and three-dimensional shapes.
- Identify and classify acute, right, obtuse and reflex angles.
- Identify and represent lines and line segments.
- Calculate the perimeter and area of simple shapes.
- Develop an understanding of volume and capacity.
- Measure accurately using appropriate metric units.

- Collect, organise, represent and interpret data.
- Read and interpret bar charts, pictograms, tally charts, tables and simple Venn diagrams.
- Use grids and coordinates to locate and describe positions.
- Apply mathematical concepts to unfamiliar and real-world problems.
- Check answers independently and correct errors where necessary.

English Language, Literacy & Communication

Learners should be able to:

- Read age-appropriate texts fluently, accurately and with appropriate expression.
- Demonstrate understanding of literal and inferential meaning.
- Identify main ideas, supporting details, sequence, cause and effect.
- Draw conclusions and make predictions using evidence from a text.
- Distinguish between fact and opinion.
- Use context clues to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words.
- Develop and confidently apply a rich and varied vocabulary.
- Use dictionaries, thesauruses and other reference materials effectively.
- Identify and correctly apply major parts of speech.
- Apply grammar, punctuation, spelling and sentence structure accurately.
- Use prefixes, suffixes, synonyms, antonyms and homophones appropriately.
- Construct well-organised paragraphs with clear topic sentences and supporting details.
- Use appropriate transition words to connect ideas.
- Write clear and coherent **narratives, descriptions, reports, letters and expository compositions.**
- Express opinions and support them with relevant reasons and examples.
- Plan, draft, revise, edit and present written work.
- Identify and correct common errors independently.
- Communicate ideas clearly and confidently in speech.
- Participate appropriately in discussions and presentations.
- Listen actively and respond thoughtfully to others.

- Ask relevant questions and seek clarification when necessary.

2.0 CRITICAL THINKING & PROBLEM-SOLVING

Learners will be encouraged to:

- Approach problems logically rather than immediately seeking answers.
- Break complex tasks into smaller, manageable steps.
- Generate and compare different solutions.
- Explain **how and why** they arrived at an answer.
- Ask meaningful questions and investigate possible answers.
- Make predictions and test simple hypotheses.
- Identify patterns, relationships and inconsistencies.
- Use evidence to support opinions and conclusions.
- Consider different perspectives before making decisions.
- Apply previous learning to new and unfamiliar situations.
- Reflect on mistakes and use feedback to improve.
- Demonstrate perseverance when a task becomes challenging.

3.0 DIGITAL & FUTURE-READY SKILLS

Technology will be used as a tool for **learning, creativity, research and responsible communication**.

Learners should increasingly be able to:

- Use computers confidently for familiar academic tasks.
- Create, save, organise and retrieve digital work.
- Use age-appropriate educational platforms and applications.
- Conduct simple research using supervised and appropriate online resources.
- Identify that information found online may not always be accurate.
- Demonstrate appropriate online safety and responsible digital behaviour.
- Understand the importance of protecting personal information.

- Demonstrate appropriate use of passwords and privacy.
- Develop awareness of digital footprints.
- Use technology purposefully without becoming dependent on it.
- Demonstrate responsible and respectful digital communication.

4.0 SOCIAL, EMOTIONAL & PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

BEL 4 learners are expected to demonstrate growing maturity and independence.

Learners should work towards being able to:

- Manage personal routines with minimal adult prompting.
- Take responsibility for personal belongings and learning materials.
- Organise materials needed for lessons and activities.
- Complete age-appropriate responsibilities independently.
- Ask for assistance appropriately when necessary.
- Manage time effectively and meet reasonable deadlines.
- Work successfully both independently and as part of a team.
- Demonstrate empathy and consideration for others.
- Communicate feelings appropriately.
- Manage frustration, disappointment and disagreement constructively.
- Accept correction and feedback without unnecessary resistance.
- Take responsibility for mistakes and make reasonable attempts to correct them.
- Demonstrate resilience when faced with challenging tasks.
- Recognise personal strengths and areas requiring improvement.
- Set simple personal and academic goals.

5.0 CHARACTER, VALUES & CITIZENSHIP

At CCMS, academic success is important, but **character determines how knowledge is used.**

Learners will be encouraged to:

- Practise honesty, respect, fairness and responsibility.
- Demonstrate kindness while respecting appropriate boundaries.
- Treat peers, teachers, support staff and visitors with dignity.
- Respect different abilities, backgrounds, perspectives and experiences.
- Understand the relationship between rights and responsibilities.
- Respect school property and the belongings of others.
- Resolve disagreements through respectful communication.
- Understand their responsibilities as members of their family, school, community and nation.
- Demonstrate responsible citizenship in age-appropriate ways.
- Make choices that contribute positively to the school community.

6.0 PROJECT-BASED & COLLABORATIVE LEARNING

Project-based learning provides learners with opportunities to apply classroom knowledge to practical situations.

Through individual and group projects, learners will develop:

- Creativity
- Research skills
- Critical thinking
- Problem-solving
- Communication
- Collaboration
- Time management
- Presentation skills
- Initiative
- Responsibility

Individual and group projects are compulsory where assigned and contribute to assessment.

Parents are encouraged to provide appropriate guidance and resources while ensuring that the learner remains the **primary thinker, creator and presenter** of the work.

7.0 THEME FOR THE SESSION

DISCIPLINE — MAKING WISE CHOICES FOR MY LIFE

At CCMS, we believe that discipline is not simply about following rules. It is about developing the **self-control, responsibility, judgement and resilience** needed to make wise choices—even when no one is watching.

Throughout the session, learners will be encouraged to:

- Understand that **every choice has a consequence**.
- Think before acting and consider the impact of their choices.
- Develop self-control and manage impulsive reactions.
- Take ownership of their actions, decisions and mistakes.
- Follow instructions and routines with increasing independence.
- Make responsible choices even when faced with distractions or peer pressure.
- Understand the difference between **what I want to do and what I should do**.
- Pause, think and choose an appropriate response when angry, frustrated or disappointed.
- Manage time responsibly and complete tasks within agreed deadlines.
- Develop the discipline to begin, sustain and complete challenging tasks.
- Care for personal belongings, school resources and shared spaces.
- Accept correction and use feedback as a tool for improvement.
- Practise honesty, respect, kindness and fairness.
- Resolve disagreements respectfully rather than reacting impulsively.
- Develop healthy habits around hygiene, learning, organisation, rest and movement.
- Understand that **greater independence comes with greater responsibility**.
- Reflect on behaviour and identify what could be done differently.
- Set personal and academic goals and take practical steps towards achieving them.
- Understand that discipline is not about being perfect; it is about **making better choices consistently**.

OUR KEY MESSAGE

“I am responsible for my choices, my actions and the person I am becoming.”

THINK • CHOOSE • ACT • TAKE RESPONSIBILITY

Throughout the session, learners will be guided to understand that:

Wise choices build strong character, and strong character helps us direct our lives.

8.0 APPEARANCE & GROOMING

Uniforms

Uniforms must be clean, neatly pressed and properly worn each school day.

Girls

- Hair should be neatly braided, plaited or styled.
- Attachments may be used in **black or brown only**.
- Hairstyles must be neat, simple and school-appropriate.
- Beads and elaborate or distracting accessories are not permitted.
- Only small stud earrings are permitted.

Boys

- Hair should be low, neat and maintained in a modest style.
- Elaborate designs, carvings, patterns or distracting styles are not permitted.

General Grooming

- Fingernails must be short and clean.
- Jewellery and distracting accessories are not permitted.
- Black shoes and white socks are required on uniform days.
- Sportswear and appropriate sneakers should be worn on designated sports days.

9.0 HEALTH, HYGIENE & NUTRITION

Learners should have breakfast at home before coming to school.

Parents should provide a nutritious packed lunch and appropriate snacks in suitable containers, together with:

- A labelled water bottle.
- Personal cutlery where required.
- A medium-sized school bag.

Meals should be balanced and nutritious. **Noodles are discouraged as a regular packed lunch** because they do not, on their own, constitute a balanced meal.

Parents should not send unnecessary toys, candy, chewing gum, biscuits, cookies, sugary drinks or money unless specifically requested by the school.

Children who are visibly unwell should remain at home and parents should notify the school appropriately.

Any prescribed medication sent to school must be clearly labelled and managed according to the school's medication procedure.

10.0 SCHOOL HOURS & PUNCTUALITY

School Hours:

8:00 a.m. – 3:15 p.m., Monday to Friday, excluding public holidays, approved school closures, emergencies or national directives.

Punctuality is part of developing discipline and responsibility.

Pick-Up

A **15-minute grace period** is allowed after closing time.

Late pick-up beyond **3:15 p.m.** will attract a **₦1,000 charge per additional hour or part thereof**.

School Bus

Bus learners should be at the designated pickup point by **7:20 a.m.**

The expected return time is approximately **4:30 p.m.**, subject to traffic and circumstances beyond the school's control.

11.0 HOME LEARNING

Homework will be purposeful and designed to reinforce classroom learning while developing independent study habits.

For BEL 4:

Maximum recommended homework time: approximately 60 minutes every other day.

Parents are encouraged to provide a quiet environment and appropriate support while allowing learners to complete their work independently.

Parents should guide the learning process rather than complete assignments on behalf of the learner.

Homework contributes to cumulative assessment where applicable.

12.0 SCHOOL PROPERTY & PERSONAL BELONGINGS

Learners are expected to respect school property and the belongings of others.

- All personal belongings should be clearly labelled.
- Learners should take reasonable care of their books, bags, bottles, lunch containers and other personal items.
- Parents may be required to replace or pay for school property damaged through deliberate or negligent behaviour.
- The school should be notified promptly regarding lost property.

13.0 FEES & SCHOOL ADMINISTRATION

All school fees are expected to be paid according to the school's approved payment schedule.

Outstanding fees may result in temporary exclusion from school activities or the learner being sent home until the account is regularised, in accordance with school policy.

Parents are encouraged to communicate promptly with the school regarding genuine concerns about fee payments.

Staff Appreciation

CCMS discourages staff from receiving **cash or personal gifts** from parents in order to promote fairness, professionalism and equality within the school community.

Words of encouragement, constructive feedback and prayers are always appreciated.

14.0 HOME–SCHOOL PARTNERSHIP

Your involvement remains an important part of your child's success.

Parents are encouraged to:

- Read school communications regularly.

- Respond promptly to important messages.
- Attend scheduled conferences and meetings.
- Encourage reading and learning routines at home.
- Promote independence and responsibility.
- Reinforce appropriate behaviour and school expectations.
- Support healthy routines, punctuality and organisation.
- Inform the school of circumstances that may significantly affect their child's learning or well-being.
- Communicate concerns respectfully through the appropriate channels.
- Participate in relevant school activities and parent-involvement opportunities.

OUR COMMITMENT TO YOUR CHILD

At BEL 4, we want learners to become increasingly capable of managing **their learning, their behaviour and their responsibilities**.

We want the learner who once asked:

“What should I do?”

to increasingly become the learner who can say:

“I have thought about it, I know my choices, and I understand the consequences.”

At CCMS, we will **teach, challenge, encourage, correct, support and celebrate** your child as they grow.

With a strong partnership between home and school, we can help develop a learner who is **academically capable, curious, resilient, responsible, respectful and confident enough to make wise choices**.

We look forward to a purposeful, productive and rewarding **2026/2027 Academic Session**.

Warm regards,

Mrs. Bukola Odomo

Head of School

Cuddles Childminders and Schools (CCMS)